

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Sentinel/SIEM Engineer | Detection Engineering | KQL | Log Onboarding | SOAR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified senior security engineer with a strong specialisation in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection development, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I have hands-on experience deploying, onboarding, and optimising enterprise-scale SIEM solutions in large hybrid environments, building custom detection content, tuning analytics rules against real-world threat activity, and automating response workflows through playbooks. I combine deep Microsoft security stack expertise spanning Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Entra ID with expert-level CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) capability. I am eager to join a leading Microsoft security partner where I can contribute to cutting-edge detection engineering and help enterprise clients derive maximum value from their Sentinel investments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel SIEM Engineering:** Enterprise log onboarding; KQL analytics rules, workbooks, and hunting queries; custom data connectors; SOAR playbook development using Logic Apps; detection-as-code practices
- **Detection Engineering:** Building and tuning high-fidelity detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK; Indicator of Attack (IoA) and Indicator of Compromise (IoC) development; threat-actor-aligned detection logic
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel automated playbooks; PowerShell scripting; response workflow automation; alert triage and enrichment pipelines
- **CrowdStrike Falcon Platform:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert level; custom detection policy development; threat hunting across the Falcon platform
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; 8,000-user deployment
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting:** PowerShell; KQL; Security automation and pipeline development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own and optimise Microsoft Sentinel SIEM operations across UAL's hybrid enterprise environment, including log onboarding from multiple data sources, analytics rule development, and SOAR playbook engineering
- Write and maintain a library of KQL detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, continuously tuning them against live threat activity to maintain detection precision and reduce false positives
- Build and refine SOAR playbooks using Microsoft Logic Apps and Sentinel automation, orchestrating automated alert triage, enrichment, and containment responses for high-priority security events
- Manage enterprise-wide CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR deployment, configuring telemetry ingestion, custom dashboards, and real-time threat hunting to complement Sentinel detections
- Integrate log telemetry from Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Mimecast, and other security controls into Sentinel to build a unified detection surface

- Partner with incident response teams during active security events, applying detection insights to tune rules against observed attacker behaviours in real time
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies, ensuring identity telemetry feeds correctly into Sentinel for Identity-based detection use cases
- Conduct threat hunting exercises across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying attacker dwell and lateral movement indicators
- Lead vulnerability management cycles using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, correlating findings with SIEM telemetry to prioritise risk remediation by business impact

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Managed day-to-day Microsoft Sentinel SIEM operations, configuring data connectors, building KQL-based analytics rules, and maintaining alert pipelines to support a 24/7 security monitoring capability
- Developed custom detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel, mapping analytics rules to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to improve coverage of adversary behaviours relevant to the higher education sector
- Deployed and onboarded Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 estate, integrating telemetry into Sentinel for unified detection
- Configured and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon EDR detection policies, Indicators of Attack (IoA), and Indicators of Compromise (IoC) to improve endpoint detection coverage
- Authored PowerShell automation scripts to accelerate SIEM onboarding tasks, log normalisation workflows, and routine security operations activities, improving team efficiency
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) operations, ensuring privileged session activity was captured as log telemetry in the SIEM for audit and detection purposes
- Conducted regular threat hunting exercises using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying latent threats not surfaced by automated alerts
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ certification, providing SIEM-derived evidence for monitoring and logging controls

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported implementation and management of security monitoring controls, contributing to log collection and alert configuration for the company's cloud and on-premises infrastructure
- Administered endpoint security tooling and assisted with policy development and configuration management across company devices
- Supported vulnerability identification and remediation workflows, collaborating with engineering teams to apply security patches and configuration hardening
- Assisted with identity and access management tasks including MFA configuration and user account lifecycle management

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and maintained an enterprise Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment at UAL, onboarding over 20 data sources and building a KQL detection library aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving comprehensive coverage of the university's threat landscape
- Built SOAR playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types by automating triage, enrichment, and initial containment steps, freeing analyst time for higher-complexity investigations
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel to create a layered, high-fidelity detection capability, combining endpoint telemetry with identity and network log sources for cross-domain threat visibility
- Onboarded Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel across an 8,000-user estate, creating unified detection rules spanning endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously test detection coverage, using simulation outputs to identify detection gaps and refine KQL analytics rules

- Developed PowerShell scripting library to automate repetitive SIEM administration tasks including connector health checks, rule deployment, and log ingestion validation

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)